R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · CLEANING AND RECODING · LESSON 1

01 Recode labels to numbers with if_else()

Turn Male and Female into 1 and 2, and back again, with mutate() and if_else().

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Change a column with mutate()
- Recode two choices with if_else()
- Convert codes back to labels

The R code in this lesson

```
# Converting a two-choice variable from label to value
demographic <- demographic %>% mutate(Gender = if_else(Gender == "Male", 1, 2))

# Converting from value back to label
demographic <- demographic %>% mutate(Gender = if_else(Gender == 1, "Male",
"Female"))
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Many analyses need codes instead of words, like one for male and two for female. In this lesson, you will learn to recode a column with mutate and if else, and then turn the codes back into clear labels. Let's practice recoding together.

0:00 We start from a fresh demographic table with short column names. In the Gender column, we see the words Male and Female.

0:35 I write two notes. Converting a two choices variable from character to numeric. And converting it back, from numeric to character.

0:45 The tool for changing a column is mutate. Demographic, arrow, demographic, pipe, mutate. Inside mutate, we say which column to change: Gender equals.

1:05 Then if underscore else. It needs three parts: a condition, the value if true, and the value if false. Just like IF in Excel.

1:30 The condition: Gender, double equals, Male. If true: one. If false: two.

1:50 Run it, and open the table. The Gender column now shows one and two. One for male, two for female.

2:15 Now let's go back. Same pattern: mutate, Gender equals, if else. But this time the condition is: Gender, double equals, one.

2:40 If true: Male, in quotes. If false: Female, in quotes. Text needs quotes, numbers don't.

3:00 Run it, and the labels are back. Mutate changes a column, and if else chooses between two values. A powerful pair! Great work.